

Your one-page river guide

SINGLE PLAYER / 20-30 MINUTE TARGET / KEEP BESIDE THE BOAT

YOUR NIGHT

One player. Finish 4 trips with at least 8 fulfilled wishes. Survive the final return. An empty shore and supply after a return ends the night early at the same target. Lose if a move costs more light than you have. Zero survives. Target: 20-30 minutes, untested with humans.

SET UP

Start with light 5/6, trip 1, tide 0, no memories or Wraiths. Shuffle Arrivals, Routes and Events separately. Draw Arrivals until at least 5 souls wait; a pair may make 6. Write each deadline: tide +5, or +3 for Fool. Reveal 2 Routes.

1 / BOARD

Choose passengers within 4 seats; Achilles takes 2. Board at least one. Passenger cards stay visible. You may change the load before departure. Read the two Routes before deciding.

2 / CHOOSE AND PAY

Choose a revealed Route. Optional: spend one memory, once only. Restore its light or change its target deadline first. Fog = route base + pressure + Wraiths + rival pair + Event - memory shield (minimum 0). Pay Killer's 1 light separately, then fog. If you cannot pay, lose. Discard both offered Routes; reshuffle discards when the pile runs out.

3 / ADVANCE AND DELIVER

After surviving, advance tide and boat move by 1. Any waiting deadline now reached becomes a Wraith, affecting the next move. At ordinary stops, deliver any passengers. Each matching wish scores 1 and earns that soul's memory; gain only 1 light total per stop with matches. Keep at most 3 memories. Unmatched deliveries give nothing.

4 / CHECK THE BOAT

After delivery, tainted passengers still aboard on move 2 become Ship Wraiths. All others still aboard on move 3 do so. Each Wraith adds 1 fog on later moves. Draw 2 new Routes if passengers remain. At 3 boat moves, return is the only next move.

5 / RETURN

Return only with an empty boat. Return base fog is 0; pressure and Wraiths still apply. You may spend one memory. Advance tide and resolve due waiting souls; no free recovery. Begin the next trip, refill the shore and reset boat moves. Reveal an Event before refill on trips 2 and 4. Pressure: +0 on trips 1-2; +1 on trips 3-4.

SPECIAL STOPS AND QUEST

Haven: no delivery; +1 light after paying, but clocks and Ship Wraiths still apply. Sanctuary: any wishes match; no light or memories, then retire its Route. Mother + Child matched together earn Passage once: before a move, send one waiting soul directly to its wish for 1 score only. Full details and an example follow in the kit.